



BURNING/RIPPING MUSIC

Want to move music out of your PC on to a CD? Make live-recordings of streaming music? Here's how

■ Burning music files on to CDs

Got a collection of your favourite Transglobal Underground numbers? You can burn custom compilations like these, and with the right tools and directions it's child's play. The tools required for this exercise are a CD-writer, CD-burning software and the songs of your choice in WAV or MP3 format. You could use the

demo version of Nero CD burning software to burn your CDs. This allows you to record your own custom audio CDs that can be played in any standard home or car stereo.

■ Install the software:

Download the demo version of the burning software from www.ahead.de. Install the application and launch it. The software prompts you with a registration screen. Click the Demo button. The software throws open an option to create a new CD or to duplicate another CD. (If it doesn't, click on **File > New**). Choose the Create New CD option and click on Next.

■ Select the type of CD:

Next, you need to choose the type of the CD. Choose it via the next window that pops up. Choose Audio CD from the options listed and proceed to the next screen to finalise.

■ Drag and Drop the files:

There will be two panes visible to you in the main Nero Window. On the left you have the explorer that you can use to locate the tracks you will record. On the right is the compilation explorer, which lists the contents of the CD. Drag and drop the files of your choice from the left pane to the right. A status bar below indicates the maximum minutes you could record. You can record

Which format do I pick?

Lossy audio compression is the JPG of music: for a minor loss of quality that you cannot discern, you have a sound file which is

many times smaller than the original and can be broadcast, swapped and played on portable media. The battle for the best compression

Codec is far from complete. Audio compression is a new concept and there are still various algorithms contesting for public approval.

Format	Pros	Cons	Go for this if
MP3	Excellent sound quality at high bitrates; versatile, portable, swappable	There is no need to pay to get a license to decode an MP3, but there is one to encode. Even if you write a free encoder, you are supposed to pay for a license	Disk space is cheap. Quality is something that once lost through over-compression and/or a poor Codec, can never be recovered
Ogg Vorbis	Open source; has plugins for popular applications such as Winamp, Sonique; supports multiple channels	Popular only among geek circles and open source zealots	You are developing an application where audio compression is needed (chat, game sound, etc). You need to pay to use this Codec. Ogg Vorbis is good for small developers
WMA	Low CPU requirements, available to anyone using Media Player	WMA 8 is copy protected	Quality requirements are not very strict and storage space is quite limited
LAME	LAME used to be Lame Ain't an MP3 Encoder. LAME is a completely open, patent-free, license-free Codec	—	Quality is highly imperative and you plan to burn high quality audio CDs
MP3 Pro	Offers you decent quality sound at low bitrates; low system requirements	SBR technology synthesises high frequencies rather than recovers them.	Your portable MP3 player has upgradeable firmware



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